

Visible microwaves

Though microwaves are invisible, their presence has been detected here using a matrix of neon lamps embedded inside a sheet of acrylic

570 megapixels!

The world's highest resolution camera is close to completion and it's going to be hunting for dark energy

Icons of Trust

as being solid, it won't break down often. Dell and Apple take the first and second spot in terms of reliability.

- Apple notebooks are also considered more technologically advanced. We feel the design and sleekness has a role to play here. Apples magical trackpad might also play a role, since it supports effortless gestures and such that other notebooks do not. Dell gets second spot here, and interestingly Sony overtakes with HP. HP notebooks are considered workhorses, and workhorses cannot be technologically advanced right?
- Kudos to Apple and Sony for aiming to be perceived as a stylish lifestyle brand. Most of our readers strongly agree that these two brands are the most stylish in terms of notebook design. Dell comes third, HP comes fourth, with Lenovo coming in fifth.
- Dell is perceived as being the most easy to use notebook, with HP/Compaq coming in second place. Sony is third, Lenovo is fourth.
- When it comes to availability, HP is voted as the most accessible brand. This makes sense for they have a lot of stores, dealers, and HPs distribution channel is rumoured to be the strongest.
- Dell has the strongest after sales support system according to a majority of our readers. Not only are queries resolved sooner, their staff is also the most knowledgeable, and repairs are performed the quickest. We feel this is a strong reason for why there is so much trust floating around for Dell.
- No surprise then, that Dell also has the most faithful consumer base. More people praise their notebooks, and recommend Dell to others. Finally, Dell is also thought to be the lightest to maintain, and associated with the lowest cost of ownership.

The most trusted

Based on collective feedback, Dell was found to be the most trusted brand, with leads in every sphere, especially a whopping lead when it comes to awareness. HP/Compaq comes in second, trailing Dell by some 6 per cent overall. HP has not been very aggressive this year, and

this is a trend we saw last year as well, although Dell's lead has grown by 1 per cent over last year. Sony trails HP/Compaq by two points, whereas last year these two were at par, although to be honest, Sony has not lost any points from last year. Although we're only interested in the top three, it bears mention that Apple has demolished Lenovo, whom they trailed last year, and now trails Sony by a single point, we're seeing a lot of new Macbooks in various avatars and this could well be the reason.

PMP (MP3) players

PMPs, or MP3 players as they're commonly called are the de facto choice of entertainment for those on the go. Imagine this, you're aboard a crowded bus, en route work. A PMP provides you the means to escape from the daily grind around you and blots out the noise, if not the pollution. However, for many, this is sufficient to keep them fresh on their way to office, and if freshness, according to you, is a state of mind, you owe it to yourself to try out a PMP. Judging from the steep hike in their sales, a lot of urbanites are jumping on this bandwagon.

Market Trends

PMPs are facing very tough competition from cellphones. These are now becoming increasingly multimedia-oriented, and previously, while a PMP could do movies, games and PIM functions other than music, the latest cellphones with their larger touch-screens are in certain cases, just as multimedia oriented. There is also a convenience issue. For why would someone travel with both a cell-phone (or two), in addition to a PMP, if just one device could suffice? The corollary to this is, that no matter how converged technology makes these gadgets, there are still dedicated portable multimedia devices that can

provide a higher level of entertainment than a similarly priced cellphone.

However, there is no strict rule for this, and whether or not a PMP, remains a subjective question. After all, do you spend ₹40,000 on a 32 GB iPhone, or do you buy a cheaper ₹10,000 cellphone and a 32 GB iPod Touch for ₹20,000, saving ₹10,000 in the bargain?

Perceptions from our survey

- What are the two names that come to mind when we say PMP? Apple? Sony? Well, our readers who participated in this survey thought so too! 19 out of 20 people will say Apple, while 15 will say Sony. The other brands hardly feature. We feel this has a lot to do with the perception these two brands have built. Today, the phrase "iPod" is actually used by 90 per cent of shopkeepers to denote any PMP, while we know that it is, in fact an Apple trademark. However, this is the market situation, and even Sony's, Cowon's and Creative's are all referred to as "iPods". Sony with their "Walkman" trademark are almost as well known.
- When we asked readers which brand they trusted, and whose quality was superior, the numbers were overwhelmingly in favour of Apple and Sony, with Apple maintaining a slight lead.
- Apple's PMPs were also voted as being more technologically advanced, and having a richer feature set. Additionally, people feel that Apple is more innovative, and innovates

